The Dhāraṇī Called "The Vow Made by Noble Tārā Herself"

Āryatārāsvapratijñā-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 1002 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་མ་སྒྲོལ་མ་རང་གིས་དམ་བཅས་པ་ཞེས་བྱ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī Called "The Vow Made by Noble Tārā Herself," known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Tārā Svapratijñā Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Pakma Drolma Rang Gi Damchepa Zhejawai Zung, is a short dhāraṇī text devoted to the female bodhisattva Tārā. After an homage to Noble Tārā, it presents her speaking a dhāraṇī-mantra that embodies the vow she herself made, and it extols its power: simply calling it to mind is said to dispel all fears, bring every accomplishment, and place all beings under the practitioner's influence. It then gives brief ritual instructions tied to auspicious days of the waxing moon, such as the eighth and fifteenth. This work is Toh 1002 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the collection of incantations and protective formulas preserved in the Tibetan canon.

In the language of India: ārya tārāsāpratijñā nāma dhāraṇī
In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī Called "The Vow Made by Noble Tārā Herself."

Homage to Noble Tārā.

Then Tārā spoke the dhāraṇī of the vow she herself had made:

tadyathā oṃ tāre tārāyai hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ samayasthite bhara bhara sarvābharaṇa vibhūṣite padma ni padma mahāpadma āsanasthite hasa hasa trailokyavarde sarvadevadānapa pūjite smadāhi bhagavati tāre smarāhī bhagavānta tathāgatasya burataḥ samayaṃ dhara dhara mahāsatva avalokite maṇikanika vicitrābharaṇe oṃ vilokāya so-and-so bhagavate tāre hrīṃ hrīṃ hrīṃ phaṭ svāhā

Merely by calling this dhāraṇī-mantra to mind, all fears are dispelled. All accomplishments are attained. All sentient beings come under one's power.

On the eighth or the fifteenth day of the waxing fortnight, one should make a great offering to Noble Tārā and then recite the mantra until one sees Tārā directly.

Whatever is wished for, that I shall grant. I bestow every supreme thing. If I do not grant it, then I have committed the five acts of immediate retribution.

Beyond this, immeasurable further benefits will arise.

Extracted from the Supreme Vajra Tantra.

The dhāraṇī of the vow made by Noble Tārā herself is complete.

Translator's Notes

• "So-and-so" renders a Tibetan placeholder within the mantra, where the practitioner inserts the name of the person or aim concerned. The first-person statements ("that I shall grant," "I have committed the five acts of immediate retribution") are Tārā's own pledge, which gives the dhāraṇī its title. The five acts of immediate retribution (ānantarya) are the gravest misdeeds, such as killing one's mother or father. By staking her own standing on them, Tārā swears she will not fail the practitioner.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.